



YOU ARE 30 WEEKS EXACTLY

70 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

Does your baby start to feel tired? Certainly on some scans it can look as if they are. In fact, your baby actually spends most of the time in a state of sleep rather than full wakefulness: it seems that during pregnancy your baby does need to spend most of the time asleep.

“ You probably won’t want to stop working just yet, but you may need to make some adjustments if you’re feeling very tired. ”

Later on in the third trimester you may begin to feel more tired than usual. The strain on your body may begin to show itself—you may find yourself uncomfortable and easily fatigued. Things that never bothered you previously, such as standing for long periods of time or walking a lot, may get increasingly difficult. For example, your trip to and from work may tire you much more than it did previously. If that is the case, find out whether you can alter your hours to avoid traveling at the busiest times of the day and, if you find yourself traveling during rush hours, don’t be shy about asking someone to give up their seat on the train for you. If there is a room in which you can rest at work, you may be able to take a short nap in the middle of the day or early afternoon, which might help to alleviate your fatigue a little.

You may want to discuss with your employer ways to make your job less physically demanding, or ask for help, for example if you need to carry heavy files or your job involves walking long distances. With a few adjustments you should be able to keep going until the start of your maternity leave, but above all, listen to your body: if you’re tired, rest; if your feet and legs hurt, sit down.

USING A BIRTHING POOL

Laboring and giving birth in water can induce relaxation and reduce blood pressure. Research shows that warm water on the lower back (the area of the spinal cord that receives the nerves from the lower abdominal region) can reduce labor pain, while the level of endorphins, or natural painkillers, rises in the same environment.

Although it can be beneficial to labor in water, there is no known benefit to water births and there is an increased risk of infection for your baby. Due to these risks, it is not recommended that you deliver in the tub or pool. You should speak with your doctor about the use of water in your birth plan so that you can make an informed decision, especially if your pregnancy is considered high risk.